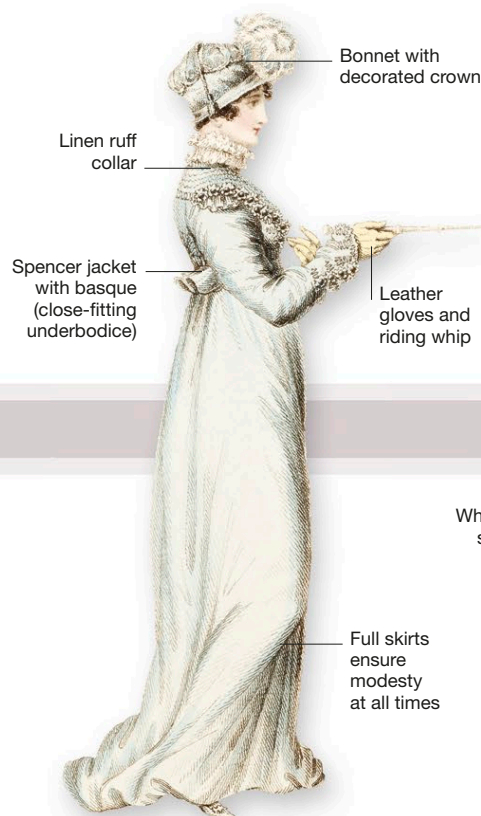




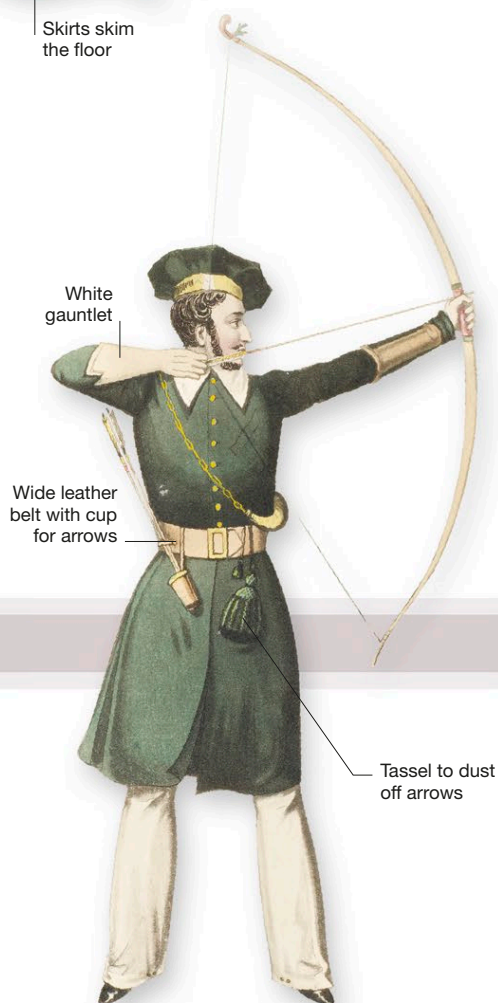
Fashionable riding dress
Brown and dark grey woollen riding habits were popular in the early 1800s. This long-sleeved jacket bodice is open to reveal a short-waisted linen "habit shirt", with frilled collar and coloured neckerchief.



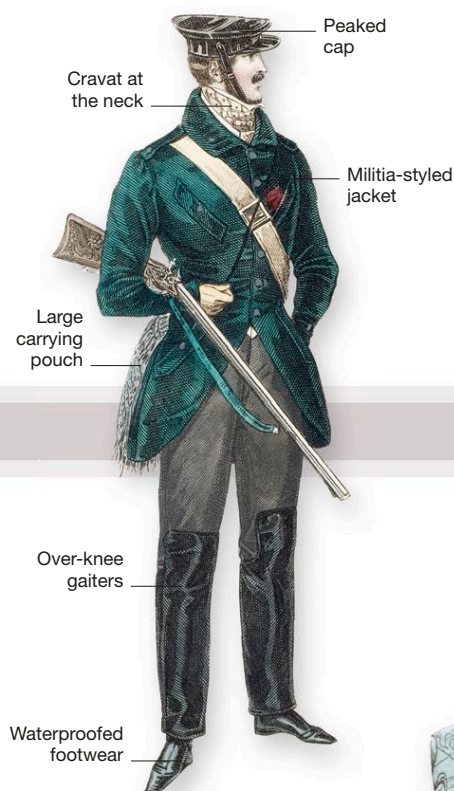
Spencer jacket With ample skirts suitable for riding side saddle, this riding outfit from 1815 would ideally have been made of green merino wool. The spencer jacket with basque may have been a separate garment.



Royal blue habit
Queen Victoria and Empress Eugénie both rode, and wore habits in this shade of blue. This 1840 habit has a roll collar to the bodice, a white shirt, and brown cravat, echoing the male hunting outfit of the time.



Gentleman archer The green coat worn by this toxophilite (lover of archery) has a button-through style like a medieval pourpoint (doublet). Belted at the waist, it is worn with a soft-crowned cap and loose trousers.



Shooting outfit Wildfowling, grouse shooting, and dry shooting required warm underclothing and sensible footwear. Recipes for waterproofing boots featured beeswax, beef suet, resin, and balsam.

RIDING VEILS

Veils appeared intermittently on women's headwear during the 19th century. They were worn with wedding dresses, as part of mourning outfits, for riding, and later, for travelling in open-carriage trains and buses and for motoring. Fine silk net and gauze, cotton muslin, black lace, and silk tulle were all used depending on the occasion. White veils on top hats would waft attractively while ladies rode side saddle. They also had a practical function to offer privacy and protection to the wearer while out in public. Below, the high neckwear and wide shoulder line set off the top hats beautifully, as do the tight curls on the temples.

